The Schwarzschild geometry is the first concrete example of spacetime curvature that we have met in this book. For this reason, and because it is so central to the properties of black holes, we shall examine it in detail.

If we had been thinking all our lives about space and time as an absolute, unified, four-dimensional spacetime "fabric," then it would be appropriate to describe the Schwarzschild geometry immediately in the language of curved (warped), four-dimensional spacetime. However, our everyday experience is with three-dimensional space and one-dimensional time, un-unified; therefore, I shall give a description in which warped spacetime is split up into warped space plus warped time.